

Guest Speaker #3 - Studying Abroad

This week's guest speaker talked about the opportunities SJSU offers for studying abroad. They showed the main opportunities and programs that are offered, which include studying at a partner university. This program allows you to earn SJSU credit while living in a dorm and studying outside of California for a summer, semester, or full year. This program is run through the SJSU Exchange, CSU IP, ISEP, and SSA partnerships. The second opportunity is Study and Travel with SJSU. This is a program where you go abroad with SJSU staff for a 1-4 week program offered during summer or winter sessions only. You can earn credit that counts as a direct transfer towards specific GE areas depending on the program. The third option is Global Internship programs. These are unpaid internships where you get to gain experience abroad with a small organization that is obligated via contract to ensure you are a part of a team within the organization and gain hands-on experience that can be placed on your resume. In addition to this, they offer time off to travel and experience the location you are in. This applies to all of the programs available. Across all of the opportunities, there are 30+ countries and 400+ programs available. Eligibility states that it is allowed for all grade levels and individuals who aren't even within SJSU at this time. However, it is recommended that freshmen wait until sophomore year, as this will allow them to get more out of the program. There is no maximum limit on the programs you can apply for and attend. The program cost varies depending on the program but covers the housing, insurance, activities, and meals, while airfare, passport/visa fees, and other personal expenses are paid out of pocket.

Jeremy Quero was also a speaker who has experienced these experiences with studying abroad in Europe at Rotterdam University of Applied Sciences, focused on Business and Society, where he adapted to the Dutch culture and traveled to 9 different countries in his free time due to the low cost and quick flight times. He also completed a Global Internship Program in Hong Kong with NOVUS Life Sciences as a Research and Production Intern.

As a CNSM student, this program stood out to me because he was focusing on engineering experience and gained real-world experience that he could both put on his resume and that helped him gain interview opportunities. The programs also serve as networking opportunities where you can meet people that you will continue to talk to for the rest of your life and career. In addition, a lot of technology companies are related to Hong Kong, so the connection helps his chances of landing a job in the job market. Jeremy's story reinforced the idea that this is all possible in a normal 4-year timeline. He actually didn't begin until year 3, as he stated that he didn't begin taking school seriously until then. I plan to finish in 4 years and hope to leave SJSU with a few internship experiences and a job lined up. This gave me hope in making me believe that this is possible in a normal timeline, and it opened my mind to the numerous opportunities that SJSU offers. The next steps for me are to look at bit.ly/SAAcosts and bit.ly/go-abroad-advising to see which Global Internship or Faculty-Led Program fields align with my networking/cybersecurity career goals and studies, and to check in with spartansabroad@sjsu.edu about timing and applying for the correct programs.